

▼ RELATED CAREERS

- ▶ **SOFTWARE ENGINEER** *see pp. 118–119*
- ▶ **ELECTRONICS ENGINEER** Designs and creates electronic equipment for use in industry, from telecommunications to manufacturing.
- ▶ **GEOPHYSICIST** Studies physical aspects of Earth, analyzing data on phenomena such as earthquakes, volcanoes, and the water cycle.
- ▶ **RESEARCH PHYSICIST** Investigates and proposes theories about the nature and properties of matter and energy. Physicists may work in academic or industrial research, or in government laboratories.
- ▶ **SATELLITE SYSTEMS ENGINEER** Uses a knowledge of electronics, computer science, and astronomy to design and build space satellites.

SKILLS GUIDE



A logical approach to solving complex problems and analyzing abstract astronomical ideas.



Advanced mathematical skills for aiding in computer modeling and conducting theoretical research.



Excellent computer skills for generating theoretical models and interpreting observational data.



Perseverance to study infrequent and slowly occurring astronomical phenomena patiently.



Attention to detail and the ability to make precise measurements and keep meticulous records.



THEORETICAL ASTRONOMER

Creates complex computer models to develop and test theories, and presents findings in reports, scientific journals, and at conferences around the world.



OBSERVATIONAL ASTRONOMER

Uses radio, infrared, and optical telescopes to gather data from spacecraft and satellites, then records and analyzes that data to test theories and predictions.



PLANETARIUM DIRECTOR

Develops exhibitions and film shows on the subject of planetary science to educate and entertain visitors, and hosts and liaises with different visitor groups, from tourists to schools.



ASTRONOMER This is an inherently academic career, so you will be expected to carry out original research, publish papers, and continue learning, as well as teach others.



ASTRONOMY PROFESSOR Teaches astronomy at undergraduate and postgraduate levels, and conducts research to contribute to our understanding of the universe.